

10 QUESTIONS BEFORE ANY DECISION

MUSD says the Board wants community input before any decision on a possible consolidation of Landers Elementary with Yucca Mesa. This checklist turns California guidance and lessons from past school closures into simple questions for the meeting.

1 NET SAVINGS

Ask: What is the net recurring annual savings after transportation, Yucca Mesa upgrades, transition costs, and Landers property costs are all counted?
Why this matters: Statewide California research found many closures did not improve district finances once all costs and enrollment losses were considered.

☐ Answered ☐ Not answered ☐ Document shown

2 ENROLLMENT LOSS

Ask: How many students can MUSD afford to lose after a closure before the projected savings disappear?
Why this matters: The same California study found closure districts often lost students after closures, which can reduce expected savings.

☐ Answered ☐ Not answered ☐ Document shown

3 WHICH COSTS ACTUALLY GO AWAY?

Ask: Which positions and recurring costs would truly disappear, and which would simply move to Yucca Mesa or elsewhere in the district?
Why this matters: Research found staffing and fixed costs often do not shrink in proportion to school closures.

☐ Answered ☐ Not answered ☐ Document shown

4 YUCCA MESA UPGRADES

Ask: What improvements are required at Yucca Mesa, what will each cost, and when will each be completed?
Why this matters: MUSD's own Enrollment Committee said Landers should close only after Yucca Mesa improvements for parking, traffic circulation, restrooms, and shared spaces.

☐ Answered ☐ Not answered ☐ Document shown

5 TRANSPORTATION PLAN

Ask: What will be the new travel time, pickup and drop-off time, and yearly transportation cost for affected families? Has MUSD mapped route-by-route travel impacts for every affected area?
Why this matters: California guidance says districts should analyze transportation cost and impacts on students with special transportation needs.

☐ Answered ☐ Not answered ☐ Document shown

6 RECEIVING SCHOOL CAPACITY

Ask: Can Yucca Mesa's cafeteria, library, restrooms, playground, parking, and drop-off areas handle the added students?
Why this matters: California guidance says capacity is more than classroom seats - core facilities and traffic design matter too.

☐ Answered ☐ Not answered ☐ Document shown

7 EQUITY IMPACT

Ask: Has the district completed an equity-impact analysis, including effects on students with disabilities and other high-need groups?
Why this matters: In Oakland, the California Department of Justice said a closure plan would have had disproportionate impacts on Black, low-income, and high-need students with disabilities.

☐ Answered ☐ Not answered ☐ Document shown

8 WHAT DO STUDENTS ACTUALLY GAIN?

Ask: What specific new programs, staffing, services or facilities will students receive because of consolidation?
Why this matters: Any claimed educational benefit should be specific, funded, and measurable—not just described in general terms.

☐ Answered ☐ Not answered ☐ Document shown

9 WHAT HAPPENS TO LANDERS?

Ask: If Landers closes, what is the written plan and yearly cost for the campus afterward?
Why this matters: California guidance warns that empty campuses still create maintenance, security, vandalism, and liability costs.

☐ Answered ☐ Not answered ☐ Document shown

10 ALTERNATIVES & FOLLOW-UP

Ask: What alternatives were evaluated using the same math, and will the district later report whether the promised savings actually happened?
Why this matters: California guidance recommends comparing alternatives, and districts should be able to show the public what the real results are afterward.

☐ Answered ☐ Not answered ☐ Document shown